

Chapter 95_1 - Don't Be Afraid

Taking advantage of the man still falling, she flew up and delivered another kick. The man cried out in pain, his body suddenly hitting the wall, then sliding down abruptly, his face landing flat on the ground.

Su Mo was already frightened to the core, her whole body drenched in sweat, as if she wanted to shrink into the wall. Blue veins bulged on her pale forehead. Ning Fuyi spun and landed, quickly crouching in front of Su Mo, taking off her outer robe and carefully offering it to her.

"Su Mo? Su Mo?" Ning Fuyi called with heartache.

At this moment, Su Mo had clearly fallen into extreme terror. She paid no attention to Ning Fuyi, even resisting anyone who approached her. She raised her hand and knocked away the outer robe in Ning Fuyi's hands, clear tears flowing from her eyes like a bubbling spring, staring with fear and hatred.

Ning Fuyi had no choice but to slowly retreat until she had distanced herself from Su Mo.

The man on the ground groaned and crawled up, covering his carrot-like nose and pointing at Ning Fuyi as he cursed: "Who dares trespass into my Qin manor? Someone, someone!"

Ning Fuyi had a belly full of anger with nowhere to vent. She turned and stood up, killing intent overflowing from her eyes. Without drawing her Emei¹ daggers, she lifted her leg onto the table, smashing the wooden table to pieces on the ground, then bent down to pick up a fallen table leg, slowly walking toward the man.

The man was already quite frightened, and seeing her murderous aura and angrily raised willow brows made him even more terrified. He rushed toward the main door, but the woman had somehow appeared at the entrance, blocking his path.

"You, you, you..." The man began to stutter, "What do you want? I'm telling you, do you know who my father is? The dignified county magistrate! You'd better know your place..."

"County magistrate?" Ning Fuyi lifted her chin slightly. "Since he's so powerful, then I'll kill you first, then chop off your hands and feet and send them to him, so he can see what kind of good son he raised."

The man became even more panicked upon hearing this. He suddenly squatted on the ground and shouted: "Don't, don't, don't, miss, don't kill me! You came before I was scared to death too! I didn't do anything. She suddenly became like this. I didn't even touch a single hair on her head!"

"I swear to heaven, if I touched a single hair on Miss Su Mo, let my father lose his official position!" He held his head and whimpered.

A county magistrate's son had only this much courage. Ning Fuyi saw his face turning green as if he was about to faint, so she didn't step forward.

"Qin Xiaoran? For a man and woman to be alone in a room is a great taboo. If you truly had no ill intentions, why did you have servants guard the door and lure her into the room alone?" Ning Fuyi backhandedly split the wooden stick, causing the man to scream several times.

Qin Xiaoran's eye sockets turned red as if he was about to cry. He looked as if he couldn't defend himself with a hundred mouths, directly sitting on the ground with weak legs, slapping his thighs: "Heaven and earth as my witness, although I am uneducated and naturally dissolute, those were all matters of mutual consent. How could I possibly force others! I do have feelings for Miss Su Mo, but I only admire her and couldn't bear to see her toiling daily in poverty and hardship. That's why I avoided my father's ears and secretly wanted to return this loan contract!"

"She entered this room herself. Just now we were standing in the courtyard when she seemed to be frightened by something and turned to run. I, I really am like snow flying in June!"

"Look, I brought this loan contract, and there are still three years of silver not yet repaid!" Qin Xiaoran pulled out a yellowed loan contract from his sleeve with a face full of grievance and threw it to Ning Fuyi.

Ning Fuyi caught it with a raised hand and glanced at it. It was indeed a loan contract.

"If you still don't believe me, wait for Miss Su Mo to recover and ask her yourself," he cowered.

Ning Fuyi threw the loan contract back to him: "You know how people outside discuss Su Mo, yet you still don't avoid the crowd's gossip and repeatedly pester her. How could you not know that people's words are fearsome and can destroy gold²? You clearly wanted to use others' mouths to force Su Mo to yield to you."

This time Qin Xiaoran said nothing. He just held his head with wandering eyes and muttered: "Even if I had other intentions, it doesn't mean I did anything to her. Besides, who are you? Miss Su Mo has no relatives or friends. What right do you have to question me on her behalf..."

"I am..." Ning Fuyi opened her mouth but was somewhat speechless. Finally, she coldly changed her words: "Who I am is none of your business. Just know that she is much closer to me than to other people!"

"Get lost." Ning Fuyi strode past him. At this time, Su Mo's emotions had calmed somewhat. She no longer resisted Ning Fuyi's approach, but her eyes had become vacant, and she could only open her mouth without making any sound.

Seeing her like this, Ning Fuyi didn't know how to touch her for a moment. Finally, she imperceptibly raised her finger and made Su Mo close her eyes to sleep.

Su Mo's cheek softly fell, and Ning Fuyi quickly reached out to support her face, feeling the soft skin beneath the veil.

"Get out. Don't think you've escaped this. When she wakes up, if she says you were the least bit improper to her, forget your father being a county magistrate - even if he were the emperor, I could chase him down and cut you down." Ning Fuyi said with her back to the man.

The sound of clanging came from behind as the man dared not say another word, crawling up and rushing out the door.

Thus, Ning Fuyi carried Su Mo and turned into flowing light, disappearing from the room.

Another incense stick's time later, Ning Fuyi had brought her back to the bamboo house at the foot of the mountain, placing her on the bed and covering her with blankets.

The woman's body was covered in sweat from fright, as if she had been drenched in rain. Ning Fuyi tried several times to brush away the dampness for her, but it was all in vain.

Jiuying and Hannya³ stood on either side of her, their gazes meeting behind her as they exchanged meaningful looks.

"What do you want to say?" Ning Fuyi spoke, her eyes reflecting the light spots coming through the window cracks.

"I want to say why didn't master directly kill that man? Dressed like a gold ingot, smooth-tongued - clearly not a good person." Hannya, well-versed in the ways of demons, made her palms crack with pressure.

"If it were before, if it were usual, I wouldn't ask many questions. Those who bully people around me, I would just raise my hand and eliminate them." Ning Fuyi said lightly, but when her gaze fell on Su Mo, it was like sunlight through a screen, softening considerably.

"But the Divine Venerable loves fairness most. She always has a scale in her heart to weigh right from wrong." Ning Fuyi sighed. "I'm afraid if I really killed the wrong person, she would blame me when she wakes up."

Hannya pouted and muttered quietly: "Sigh, it seems that as long as this Divine Venerable is around, master's grand ambition to dominate the world will be stillborn."

Jiuying beside her raised a slender finger, and Hannya's mouth was locked shut, muffled closed.

"Shut up, stinking crow," Jiuying said leisurely.

Ning Fuyi was too lazy to pay attention to the demon-hearted Hannya. She just stared at Su Mo. After a while, Su Mo's tear-droplet-laden eyelashes finally trembled, as if she was about to wake up. Jiuying and Hannya quickly turned and flew out the window lattice.

Su Mo opened her eyes at this moment. Fear had not yet faded from her eyes initially, but when she saw Ning Fuyi, her whole body trembled again, and she instinctively shrank toward the wall corner.

Ning Fuyi quickly raised her hands in front of her and silently stepped back a large step.

This action successfully eased Su Mo's wariness. Su Mo's eyelashes fluttered as she released her tightly gripped blanket.

Only then did Ning Fuyi speak: "What happened to you? Did that Qin Xiaoran bully you?"

Su Mo was stunned, then gently shook her head.

Ning Fuyi breathed a sigh of relief. She had been worried all along that if that dog Qin Xiaoran had really done something to Su Mo, she would never be able to forgive herself for the rest of her life.

"Then why would you..." Ning Fuyi said softly.

Su Mo lowered her head and stopped speaking, obviously unwilling to reveal this matter. Ning Fuyi had to compromise and nodded: "If you don't want to say, I won't ask."

"Also, I didn't mean to follow you. I just saw you weren't at your residence and was worried, so I asked the shopkeeper where you went to sell medicinal herbs." Ning Fuyi explained.

Her hurried explanation, afraid that Su Mo would be angry, looked somewhat cute. Su Mo clenched her hands hidden in her sleeves and gestured: "It's fine."

"I'm alright now, you..."

Before Su Mo could finish gesturing, Ning Fuyi interrupted her, glancing toward the roof beams: "I want to stay here another night."

"I'm worried about you."

She said this with both lack of confidence and righteousness, quite contradictory. Su Mo looked down uncomfortably, neither agreeing nor objecting.

Perhaps such direct concern made her somewhat at a loss.

"You haven't eaten yet, have you? I'll go cook for you." Ning Fuyi smiled at her, then turned and went out. Her night-dark skirt flowed past the threshold, shadows revealing the passionate red in the folds.

Su Mo dared not look at her back and silently lay down.

To appear well-behaved in front of Su Mo so that Su Mo would accept her, Ning Fuyi didn't say much all day. A grand Demon Lord spent the whole day bustling around the courtyard, not only successfully cooking a whole table of dishes but even wiping the mud-fired stove spotless.

She felt she was very successful at pretending to be pure and kind. This time Su Mo didn't refuse her kindness and lowered her head to eat what she had made.

Footnotes

1. **Emei (峨眉)** - Refers to Emei daggers, traditional Chinese weapons associated with the Emei martial arts school
2. **People's words are fearsome and can destroy gold (人言可畏众口铄金)** - A Chinese idiom meaning that collective gossip and rumors can be destructive, even capable of "melting" gold
3. **Hannya (寒鸦)** - Literally means "cold crow," likely a demon/spirit companion of Ning Fuyi

